

March

6

2018

Message in a bottle

The world's oldest message in a bottle was discovered on a beach on Wedge Island, Australia. Dated 12 June, 1886, it had been thrown into the Indian Ocean from a German ship named *Paula*, which was tracking ocean currents.



Born this day

1475 Michelangelo, Italian Renaissance painter and sculptor. He sculpted the marble masterpiece *David* and painted the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel in Vatican City.

Battle of the Alamo

This key battle in the Texas War of Independence ended when thousands of Mexican soldiers overthrew a group of Texans who had spent 13 days defending the Alamo, a Catholic fortress and mission, near modern-day San Antonio, USA.

1836

Independent Ghana

1957

Citizens celebrated all over Ghana as British colonial rule came to an end. Ghana was one of the first African nations to gain independence from colonial powers.

Also on this day

1204 The Siege of Château Gaillard in France ended when French soldiers climbed up a toilet chute to sneak in and conquer the English-owned fortress.

1835 The maid of Scottish author Thomas Carlyle accidentally burned his manuscript for *The French Revolution: A History*. He rewrote the book from memory and it became a bestseller.

1930 The first frozen foods, packaged as Birds Eye Frosted Foods, became available to shoppers in Springfield, Massachusetts, USA.

